

ZOE MEZIERE

EVOLUTIONARY BIOLOGY - MOLECULAR ECOLOGY - CONSERVATION GENOMICS

EXPERTISE AND INTERESTS

I am interested in the evolution of climate-threatened marine organisms. My research combines genomic, spatial, environmental and phenotypic data to explore how the genetic diversity and evolutionary history of natural populations shape adaptive responses to environmental change.



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Dutton Park, QLD, Australia

EDUCATION

2021-2025 The University of Queensland (Australia)

PhD in Population Genomics

Genetic diversity, connectivity and adaptation in Great Barrier Reef corals

Supervisors: Prof. Cynthia Riggins, Dr. Iva Popovic, A/Prof. Cheong Xin Chan

2017-2019 Uppsala University (Sweden) and Ludwig Maximilian University (Germany)

MSc in Evolutionary Biology (MEME)

Restoration ecology at the borders of the Serengeti National Park: spatial and temporal comparison of herbaceous vegetation and remote sensing land mapping

Genomic and transcriptomic insights from cultivated JS1 bacteria from deep Atlantic sediments

Supervisors: Prof. Han Olff and Prof. William Orsi

2014-2017 Université Pierre et Marie Curie at Station Biologique de Roscoff (France)

BSc in Biology and Mathematics (dual major)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025-present Australian Institute of Marine Science (Australia)

Research scientist in Population Genetics and Bioinformatics

2025-2026 The University of Queensland (Australia)

Post-doctoral research fellow in Population Genomics

PUBLICATIONS

Meziere, Z., Prata, K., Lechene, M., Ferrari, R., Popovic, I., & Riginos, C. (2025). Connectivity differs by orders of magnitude among co-distributed corals, affecting spatial scales of eco-evolutionary processes. *Science Advances*, 11(27), eadt2066. <https://doi.org/10.1126/sciadv.adt2066>

Media coverage: ABC article, ABC radio interview, various news articles, 182 total mentions

Riginos, C., Popovic, I., **Meziere, Z.**, Garcia, V., Byrne, I., Howitt, S., Ishida, H., Bairos-Novak, K., Humanes, A., Scharfenstein, H., Richards, T., Briggs, E., Clark, V., Lei, C., Khan, M., & Prata, K. (2024). Cryptic species and hybridisation in corals: Challenges and opportunities for conservation and restoration. <https://doi.org/10.32942/X2502X>

Meziere, Z., Popovic, I., Prata, K., Ryan, I., Pandolfi, J., & Riginos, C. (2024). Exploring coral speciation: Multiple sympatric *Stylophora pistillata* taxa along a divergence continuum on the Great Barrier Reef. *Evolutionary Applications*, 17(1), e13644. <https://doi.org/10.1111/eva.13644>

Meziere, Z., Rich, W. A., Carvalho, S., Benzoni, F., Morán, X. A. G., & Berumen, M. L. (2021). Stylophora under stress: A review of research trends and impacts of stressors on a model coral species. *Science of The Total Environment*, 151639. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.scitotenv.2021.151639>

SKILLS AND FIELD EXPERIENCE

Programming: R, Bash, Python, HPC usage

Genomic data processing and analysis: reduced-representation sequencing data (IPYRAD, Stacks), whole-genomic data (GATK), population structure (STRUCTURE, ADMIXTURE), demographic inference (dadi, Treemix), kinship analyses (COLONY, KING), genotype-environment and genomic offset analyses (RDA, WZA, LFFM, gradient forest), outlier scans (PCAdapt, OUTFLANK), gene ontology analyses

Diving and boating: PADI divemaster and nitrox, 400+ hours on SCUBA, AIMS-registered diver, recreational boating licence, extensive experience of long scientific expeditions and remote living

First-aid: PSC1, EFR, HLTAID009, HLTAID010, HLTAID011, HLTAID015

Experimental work: experimental design, coral fragging, aquaria maintenance during heat-stress experiments, time-series monitoring and phenotyping

Laboratory work: DNA and RNA extraction, GBS library preparation, PCR and qPCR, electrophoresis, microscopy

GRANTS AND AWARDS RECEIVED

2025	Best student publication award at the 2025 International Congress for Conservation Biology
2024	First place at the School of the Environment Research Showcase
2024	Best photograph award at the 2024 Australian Coral Reef Symposium
2023-2024	UQ Marine Research Station Grant (AUD\$ 3,500 in bench fees and accomodation)
2021-2025	University of Queensland Training Stipend (AUD\$28,597 per annum)
2019-2020	Groningen University Fund (€500) and Marco Polo Scholarship (€500)
2019-2020	PROSA Stipendium (€1900)
2018	Sohan Travel Award (€200)
2017-2018	Bourse de mobilité Sorbonne Universités (€500)

CONFERENCES ATTENDED

2025	West Pacific Marine Biology Symposium, Brisbane Australia (talk)
2025	Australasian Evolution Society conference, Brisbane Australia (talk)
2025	Gordon Research Evolutionary and Ecological Genomics, Luca Italy (poster)
2025	International Congress for Conservation Biology, Brisbane Australia (poster)
2024	Australian Coral Reef Society, Perth Australia (talk)
2023	UQ Postgrad conference, Stradbroke Island Australia (talk)
2022	Australian Coral Reef Society conference, Brisbane Australia (talk)
2022	UQ Postgrad conference, Stradbroke Island Australia (talk)
2022	Australian Marine Sciences Association conference, Cairns Australia
2019	Meeting of the African Bio Services, Arusha Tanzania Consortium (talk)
2018	5th Young Reef Scientists meeting, Munich Germany
2018	Horizontal Gene Transfer and LUCA conference, Athens Greece
2018	Joint congress in Evolutionary Biology, Montpellier France
2017	European Society of Evolutionary Biology conference, Groningen The Netherlands

INVITED TALKS

2026	DartR workshop: protecting biodiversity with genomics and R (co-presented of Landscape Genetics session)
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TRAININGS AND WORKSHOPS

2026	SLiM (Selection on Linked Mutation) forward population genetic simulation workshop
2025	AI in research workshop
2024	Outlier Analyses Workshop (Australian BioCommons)
2024	Advanced Spatial Statistics (Physalia)
2022	Summer School on Software and Statistical Methods for Population Genomics
2022	Coral Identification Workshop by Russel Kelley
2018	MANEA - Coral Reef Biodiversity (CRIOBE)

TUTORING EXPERIENCE

2025	UQ BIOL3000 Conservation
2025	UQ CONS7024 Marine Conservation
2024	UQ BIOL3215 Coral Reef Ecology and Conservation
2023-2025	UQ MARS1001 Living Oceans
2023	UQ International Programs field trip
2022-2023	UQ BIOL3209 Biodiversity and Systematics
2021-2022	UQ BIOL1020 Genes, Cells and Evolution

VOLUNTEERING AND SERVICE

2022-present	Reviewer for <i>Molecular Ecology</i> , <i>Journal of Biogeography</i> , <i>Evolutionary Applications</i> , <i>Scientific Reports</i>
2021-2022	Vice president of the UQ Biology Postgraduate Club
2020-2021	Visiting student at the Reef Ecology Lab at KAUST University